

II ①¹² One of the reasons why the appointment came as such a surprise, however, is that Gilbert is comparatively^① little known. ② Even Tommasini, who had advocated Gilbert's appointment in the *Times*, calls him "an unpretentious^② musician with no air^③ of the formidable^④ conductor^⑤ about him." ③ As a description of the next music director of an orchestra^⑥ that has hitherto^⑦ been led by musicians like Gustav Mahler and Pierre Boulez, that seems likely to have struck at least some *Times* readers as faint praise.

但是,该任命让人感到如此意外的原因之一是,吉尔伯特相对不为人知。甚至连曾在《纽约时报》上撰文大力支持任命吉尔伯特的托马西尼也(只是)称其为“谦逊的音乐家,在他身上没有那种令人生畏的大指挥家派头”。对于一个迄今为止一直由像古斯塔夫·马勒和皮埃尔·布列兹这样的音乐家来指挥的交响乐团,这样描述其下任音乐总监,似乎至少可能会让一些《纽约时报》的读者觉得是一种牵强的赞美。

· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·

- ① **comparatively** [kəm'pærətɪvli] *ad.* 比较上,相对地
② **unpretentious** [ˌʌnpri'tenʃəs] *a.* 不爱炫耀的
③ **air** [eə] *n.* 感觉;印象;神态
④ **formidable** [ˈfɔːmɪdəbəl] *a.* 可怕的;令人敬畏的
⑤ **conductor** [kən'dʌktə] *n.* 指挥家

⑥ **orchestra** ['ɔːkɪstrə] *n.* 管弦乐队

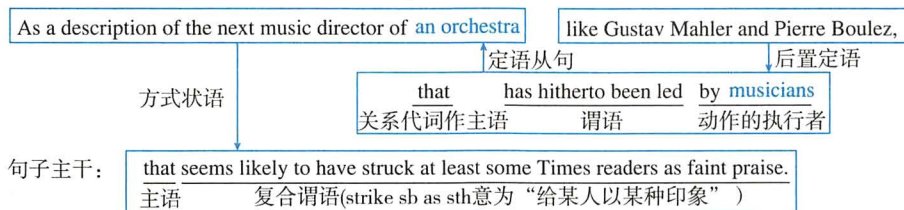
⑦ **hitherto** [ɪhɪðə'tuː] *ad.* 迄今

● 经典搭配

① with no air of (没有……的架子)

② strike... as... (给某人以……印象)

As a description of the next music director of an orchestra that has hitherto been led by musicians like Gustav Mahler and Pierre Boulez, that seems likely to have struck at least some *Times* readers as faint praise.



功能注释:本句主干为 that seems likely to have struck... as faint praise, 主语 that 承上指代。As 引导的状语中, a description of... 与主语 that 同指, 且其中嵌套一个 that 定语从句修饰 an orchestra, 说明由有影响力的大音乐家挂帅是纽约爱乐乐团一直以来的惯例。

· 语篇分析 ·

第二段介绍古典音乐界高度赞赏的主旋律之外“存有的疑虑”(Gilbert 不够知名)。关键词为: comparatively little known.

①句提出段落主旨:古典音乐界对任命感到意外的原因是 Gilbert 不够知名。转折词 however 将话题由上段古典音乐界的“强烈赞赏”转至本段“质疑之音”。such a surprise 提取上段 sudden, has been the talk 及 For the most part 等暗含信息:这一任命不同寻常、令人意外,古典音乐界高度赞赏中夹杂些许疑虑。原因句式 One of the reasons why... is that... 直接指向其疑虑:Gilbert 相对不为人知。句中 comparatively 语义内涵为:Gilbert 并非真的毫无名气,只是相对“纽约爱乐乐团(注:历史最悠久的乐团之一,位列美国五大交响乐团)音乐总监”之位不够出名。

②③句例证古典音乐界这一疑虑。As a..., that seems likely to... 表明两句间“述一评”逻辑。

②句再次引述 Tommasini 话语,侧重说明 Gilbert 的不够出名。递进强调词 Even 凸显本句和①句间“提出观点—给出典型例证”的逻辑,并在句内设置矛盾、以凸显 Gilbert 的“不知名”:who 引导的从句回应上段末句,强调 Tommasini 专门报上撰文对任命表示强烈支持;主句则引原话指出 Tommasini 对 Gilbert 的评价相当低调——谦逊的、没有令人生畏神态的指挥家派头的音乐家。整句深层内涵:就连如此支持任命的音乐评论家也只能说到这个份上, Gilbert 的不出名可想而知。